

eventually come out of the child's pocket. What's key is to not place essentials on the same plane as extras. When your kids say, "I really need this," correct them quickly. "You *want* this, you do not need it." Teach them the difference between a need and a want. And if they attach some kind of value to the product that is disproportionate or inappropriate, say so.

Money Mistake: Your Kids Don't Understand the Value of Work

THE FIX: TEACH THEM TIME IS MONEY

I was around sixteen years old when I first discovered the relationship between time, money, and me. It snowed for twenty-six days, almost the entire month of January, which meant multiple school closings—the definition of heaven for a teen like me. My brother and I were beginning to make a pretty good income keeping our driveway clear. For the first time, my parents were paying us daily for something we used to have to do every once in a while for free. After all, we were old enough and big enough to take on this responsibility full-time. We were also earning minimum wage, which was about \$1.50 an hour, and the snow was relentless. We would be drying our snow pants when another two feet would fall and we'd head back out to clear the sidewalks all over again. But it was hard, backbreaking work, even for a couple of healthy teenagers.

One day, our elderly neighbor across the street approached us while we were clearing the last of the afternoon snow. She noticed how diligently we shoveled our own driveway and offered to pay us more to shovel hers. Shane and I looked at each other. Clearing just one driveway was hard. Doing two would be harder still, and this would leave us no time to enjoy the winter. We really didn't want to do both driveways. So the question became: Which job do we take? Do we work for our family for less than what we'd make working for our neighbor? Shane and I presented the problem to our parents. My stepfather didn't seem concerned. Surely we understood that it was more important to shovel our *own* driveway than the neighbor's.